Basics of *Questguard RPG*

Welcome!

Well met, adventurer! ..., you are in the right place! In this guide you will find all about roleplaying and Questguard - how to create a character, how to play the game, a glossary of all rules and a section with several tips for Quest Masters.

Warning - This Intro section is still heavily Work In Progress.

Groups (and our community)

Questguard has a dedicated community on Discord where we always organize new campaigns and sessions for players both new and old.

Hit Play With Us! in the upper corner of the menu to see our Discord, and find people to play with!

If you want to play, sometimes it's as easy as creating a character outside of a game, finding a group to play with via an online platform and just joining the game. However, tabletop RPG's can be so much more than just a one-time experience!

Many QM's choose to run 'campaigns', which is a series of game sessions that continue from one play session to another, and expand into an overarching story and develop the players' characters' personalities and powers.

Thus, if you want it to be a more intricate experience, you should find a group that fits you; make sure you get on well with everyone else and everyone is on the same page when it comes to playing.

Each QM is different. A QM might run a story based on the Lord of the Rings books or in some made up world. Some QM's have different styles of playing - some are more focused on telling a story, others are more focused on giving the players options. Some are friendly, some... less so.

Ultimately, just like finding a group to play board games with, you all should have roughly the same expectations and mindset. Some games are more relaxed, drinking and eating pizza. Some are more intense and take things seriously. If you find a group, make sure you ask what kind of group they are.

Most groups have one Quest Master and between 3 and 6 other players who play as individual characters.

The recommended sweet spot for Questguard is one Quest Master and 4 to 5 other players.

A play session can last as long as the group desires. Usually, you should dedicate at least 1:30 to 2 hours to a play session. A lot of players find they want to keep going after that, since time flies fast when you're having fun and making progress through the story!

Learning the rules

If you never played a Table-Top Roleplaying Game, we recommend you watch this video, to get a grasp of what QuestGuard is: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2PEt5RdNHNw

If you want to try Questguard specifically and you have experience with Dungeons and Dragons (5th edition or One D&D), see the Transition Guide (From D&D)" page, in the Learn To Play menu. It will provide you an easy introduction to Questguard from a D&D perspective.

If you never played a tabletop RPG but you have friends who have played Dungeons and Dragons, send them a link to the "D&D to CoH transition guide" page!

If you decide to play online, there are several platforms for playing Questguard that simulate real life tables with miniatures, dice, music, etc. As of 2023, the most popular such platform is Roll20 (https://roll20.net). It is free for all players and Quest Masters alike and supports many roleplaying games, including Questguard.

The complete new player guide is currently TODO/Work In Progress.

Using this guide

TODO

Using the Website

To find a certain rule, you can press Ctrl + F on a desktop (or use the Find function on mobile) to find the rule you're looking for.

All the Races, Classes, Feats, Abilities, etc can be found under Database.

How To Make A Character

How To Make A Character

Download the friendly PDF "Character Creation Guide" from the Learn To Play section.

Character Creator

No time to read the guide? Don't worry, we've got you covered! QuestGuard features a complete online Character Creator, that takes you step-by-step through character creation. Login using Google, and get going! All your Heroes will be saved in the cloud, so you can access them from any device.

Character Sheets

If you like to use pen and paper, there are several types of character sheets. You can find them all at Game, under the Character Sheets section.

We recommend downloading the PNG version, or filling the PSD version using a free tool like Photopea.

Stats and Attributes

Stats

There are 5 Stats in QuestGuard, and these reflect your strengths and weaknesses: Might (physical strength and pain tolerance), Instinct (speed and agility), Focus (knowledge and magic prowess), Presence (the 5 senses and willpower), and Presence (social game and initiative).

Each of these 5 Stats affects a Combat Attribute of your Hero.

- **Might:** Increases your maximum Health (each Might increases your Max Health by 3).
- **Instinct:** Increases your Movement Speed (each Instinct increases your Movement Speed by 0.5 meters).
- **Focus:** Increases the number of Spells and Abilities you can have (each Focus allows you to pick an extra Talent, explained later). Depending on your Race, Focus might also affect the number of Languages you know and the number of Non-Combat Skill Points.
- **Presence:** Increases your Health Regen after combats (each Presence increases your Health Regen by 2).
- **Presence:** Increases the number of Actions you can take on the first Turn each combat (each Presence increases your Initiative by 0.5).

Stat Limit

The baseline Stat limit is 3, and increases by 1 every 3 Levels (3 for Levels 1 to 3, 4 for Levels 4 to 6, 5 for Levels 7 to 9, and unlimited from Level 10).

You may not go above the Stat Limit in any way, other than with buffs, magic items, and Abilities that explicitly say they can go over the Stat Limit.

Otherwise, if your Stat would be increased above the Stat Limit, nothing happens and the bonus is lost.

Non-Combat Skills

You may have bonuses to certain non-Combat Skills, which will be written explicitly on your Hero Sheet.

For example, you may have +2 in Occultism, which will give you +2 to all Rolls about knowing "occult" or dark information (the main Stat you're using doesn't matter).

Note that you add the Skill bonus on top of the Stat you're using for the main Check (e.g. if you have +2 in Occultism, and 3 Focus, you would roll 2d6 + 2 + 3).

Skill Points

When creating your Hero, you have a number of non-combat Skill Points equal to 2 + Focus, which you can use to give your Hero bonus to Rolls for certain activities.

For example, you can spend 2 Skill Points to write that you have +2 in Acrobatics (+2 to all Rolls that can be interpreted as "acrobatics", like jumping and performing backflips).

In Questguard, there isn't a list of Skills with bonuses written directly on your Hero Sheet or elsewhere.

You determine yourself how Skilled you are in any activity of your choosing.

Think of any specific activity! Sight, smell, and other bodily senses are also Skills.

Skills are often up to interpretation. For example, the Quest Master might ask you for a general Roll to see if you can spot the spy, and it is up to you to mention you are Skilled in something that would help you. Try to come up with a reason why your Skill can be applied in this situation!

Skill Limit

A Skill you have can't be higher than your highest Stat.

If it's higher than your highest Stat, clamp the bonus to that number (e.g. if you have +4 in Fishing but your highest Stat is 3 in Focus, your bonus for Fishing will only be +3 until you reach 4 in Focus).

Golden Rules of Questguard

1. Rule of Common Presence

When in doubt about a ruling or if a text leaves something up to interpretation, apply common sense.

The Quest Master has the final say, and may apply the Rule of Cool instead.

2. Always Round Down

The final number of all calculations is always rounded down (if it's positive).

At no point are calculations intended to take decimals into account, even if several multiplications happen.

2B. Ignore Fractions

The game may have fractions in certain numbers, most commonly some numbers may have a ".5" (for example, 2.5 or 0.5, or even -1.5).

Whenever you encounter such a number, simply ignore the extra digits after the dot: 2.5 becomes 2, 0.5 becomes 0, and -1.5 becomes -1.

3. Rule of Calling Out

Some Abilities have effects that happen randomly, at the roll of a die, or apply generally. In gaming, the moment such an effect happens is usually called a "proc".

To keep the game fast, a player is responsible for calling out procs, percentages increases or decreases, etc. If a "proc" happens but nobody notices it, it does not apply if they remember about it too late.

Keep track of your "procs", bonuses and triggered effects! If you forget to use them, you lose them!

The same should apply for the Quest Masters - avoid remembering later that a monster forgot to use one of its Abilities, unless you really, really have to.

4. Teamwork

Heroes should be adventurers who are eager to go explore, solve mysteries and defeat monsters.

Play together! You win together, as a team. Share

responsibilities, spotlights, and distribute loot fairly.

Free Roleplaying

Scenes

The adventure might be divided into scenes. A Scene might represent players being in a town, exploring a forest, walking down a road, etc.

In a Scene, each Hero has 1 or more Roleplay Action Points, which they can spend to choose to do something (e.g. go shopping, go talk to someone, explore the outskirts, etc).

Each player takes turns round the table doing one Free Roleplay Action, one by one. After players no longer have any Free Roleplay Action Points, the scene ends.

It is up to the Quest Master do determine how many Roleplay Action Points the players have. This can range from 1 Free Roleplay Action Point per player for shorter scenes (or when players have limited time), to 3 or even more Free Roleplay Action Points.

If not sure how many Free Roleplay Action Points to give, 2 is a good number!

Free Roleplay Actions

A player can spend 1 Free Roleplay Action Point to do something that takes time. Usually, spending a Free Roleplay Action Point consists of going somewhere, talking to someone, making non-Combat Rolls, etc.

Rolls (Checks)

A non-Combat Roll is a 2d6 die roll - you roll 2 6-sided dice to determine how well you do, and you add any modifiers you have to that.

If the Quest Master tells you to make a Might Roll, you will roll 2d6 and add your Might stat to the result.

If you have any specific non-Combat Skills, you can add those to the roll if they apply.

Rolling doubles means somoene will get a Plot Point!

Generally, a Check's required number will depend on its difficulty, as established by the Quest Master, requiring at least a number to pass:

- ◊ Trivial: 4
- ◊ Easy: 7
- ◊ Medium: 10
- ◊ Hard: 13
- ◊ Very Hard: 16

And so on.

The Quest Master is free to change the required number based on the task a Hero wants to achieve

Rolling Doubles for Plot Points

Whenever a Worthy* Check rolls equal numbers, that Check will produce a Plot Point, either for the Quest Master or the players as a group, whether or not the Check succeeded.

If the Check was a success, the player group gains a Plot Point, which they can spend later.

If it was a failure, the Quest Master gains a Plot Point.

Plot Points

Players can decide together to spend a Plot Point to do one of the following:

- Introduce an _actually_ fact to the current situation

The Quest Master can spend a Plot Point to do one of the following:

- Introduce an _actually_ fact to the current situation

- Fast-forward time in a way condusive to the plot

- Introduce other complications

In dire need, the Quest Master may also use Plot Points to cancel the effects of a player's Plot Point, but this should be done sparingly.

PLOT POINTS: ACTUALLY FACT

To introduce an _actually_ fact to the current situation, spend a Plot Point and simply make a statement starting with "Actually".

The fact must be reasonable, fitting, and approved by the Quest Master. The fact can not instantly solve the encounter, and the Quest Master may twist it slightly.

Facts can introduce regular physical objects to the scene, ammend a small mistake or oversight, introduce a connection between two characters, or even alter

names, looks, or similar traits of people or places.

Here are some examples of facts for the players:

- ◊ Actually, there is a tree between me and the enemy.
- ◊ Actually, I did buy that Health Potion from the shop
- ◊ Actually, my Hero and this person know eachother.
- ◊ Actually, I didn't jump the cliff and fail, I stopped right before.
- ◊ Actually, the name of this NPC is actually Leonard Jackson
- ◊ For the Quest Master, a fact can also introduce a complication, or force a character to act according to their backstory and quirks.

Here are some examples of facts for the Quest Master:

- ◊ Actually, the place is more heavily guarded than it seemed.
- ◊ Actually, when falling down the cliff, you further injure your arm.
- ◊ Actually, your character is afraid to approach the strange man.

Note that the Quest Master shouldn't use facts to actively hurt the players, but to introduce interesting plot ramifications!

There are plenty of ways to introduce truths, and ultimately, the Quest Master has the final word on whethere a fact is accepted.

PLOT POINTS: FAST FORWARD

The Quest Master may spend a Plot Point to advance time outside of Combat.

The time advanced this way must be proportional to the current pacing of the game.

For example, if the pacing of the situation is by the minute, the Quest Master can force a time skip of a few minutes (e.g. when the players are actively haggling with a vendor, or are engaged in a discussion going nowhere).

If the passing pacing is more slow, the Quest Master may skip time to advance the plot faster (e.g. when exploring the country side, shopping for items, etc).

The primary use of the fast-forward is to skip over time that is not meaningful to the plot, can not result in a positive scenario, or is derailing the adventure.

In certain conditions, doing a time-skip can be used to end a Combat early, but only when the result of the Combat is already clear.

Here are some examples of fast-forwarding:

- ◊ Fasting forward, you finished shopping for goods and are now in the town square.
- ◊ Fasting forward, this conversation lead no where and you were seen out by the guards.
- ◊ Fasting forward, you kept investigating the room and found no extra evidence, and are now outside-
- ◊ Fasting forward, the Combat ended in a clear victory and you are now in camp, having collected the valuable materials from the monster.

Rolling With Events

If you roll 2 of the same number on a non-Combat Roll, you roll with Events!

Based on the numbers rolled, something extra might happen. If you rolled numbers were low (e.g. 1 or 2), something bad might happen. If you rolled high (5 or 6), something good might happen.

Social Etiquette

Be nice and don't interrupt others; try to make decisions as a team.

Wait for your turn, unless given permission by other players and the Quest Guard to have priority.

Crafting

Crafting Basics

A craftsman can craft an item for a total price equal to its regular cost, but it can take 1 up to 7 days (in-game) depending on the item crafted.

You can order a custom crafted regular item with a different look!

You can provide the crafter with materials worth an amount of Gold, which will be subtracted from the original cost.

Crafting Components

A craftsman can take extra Crafting Components to add to the item to create a custom Magic Item for an extra 200 Gold.

Crafting components are objects that add properties to items, such as a Weapon Component - Poison Gland (converts Damage to Poison for weapons).

Crafting Components are usually obtained

from slain monsters or found in the wild.

Price of Crafting Components

Adding only one Crafting Component to a crafting order costs 150 Gold. After that, each extra Component costs twice as much.

Adding 1 Component costs 150 Gold.

Adding 2 Components costs 300 Gold (150 * 2).

Adding 3 Components costs 600 Gold (300 * 2).

Adding 4 Components costs 1200 Gold (600 * 2).

And so on.

You can find these prices at the Game menu, under the Other section, on the Shop & Prices page.

Harvesting Components

Harvesting regular Components may require a Roll above 10.

Getting doubles may instead let you harvest a Rare Component.

Each monster's harvestable parts can be found in its Loot section.

Player Tools

Character Sheets

You can find all types of Character Sheets (PDF, PNG, PSD) under Game > Other.

Ability Tracker (Online)

For keeping track of all your Abilities, you can use the Ability Tracker tool, which should be self explanatory.

You can find it at the Game menu, under the Abilities section, on the Ability Sheet Maker page.

You can save these by saving the URL of the page. Whenever you make a modification to the sheets, the URL changes automatically. Make sure you have backups!

Combat Rundown

Combat By Turns

Tactical combat is a large part of what makes Questguard fun and interesting!

During Combat, players and monsters take Turns.

Turn Order (Initiative)

Warning: The rules for turn Order are still being tested and are TODO/WIP.

Players take Turns clockwise (or counter-clockwise), starting from the left-most player (though the order rules are still being tested and are work-in-progress).

Enemy groups take turns inbetween players. All Enemies of a type act at the same time.

Monster Setback

Monsters have an extra Attribute that Heroes don't - Setback. A monster's Setback represents after how many Heroes Turns the monster may take its Turn.

For example, a monster with 1 Setback takes its Turn after the first Hero finished its Turn this Round. A monster with 3 Setback takes its Turn after the 3rd Hero finished its Turn this Round. A monster with 0 Setback takes its Turn before all Heroes.

If a monster's Setback is higher than the number of players, it just takes its Turn last.

If multiple monsters have the same Setback, they take their Turns at the same time (or in any order).

Ambush

If one or more Units want to attack another party, and that party would logically have no time to react, that party take Turns first.

If no-one ambushed, monster groups take Turns between Player Turns.

For example, wanting to shoot an arrow out of nowhere, or a rogue wanting to fall from the ceiling upon the unsuspecting enemies, would probably be an ambush.

Being prepared to strike as an enemy walks through a door would also normally be an ambush.

Running from behind a tree toward the enemy to strike them with a sword would normally not be an ambush, since it takes time to reach the enemy, during which the enemy can react.

It is ultimately up to the Quest Master and common

sense whether something is an ambush or not.

If the enemies still have higher Initiative than an ambushing Unit, that Unit is free to not do what they wanted to do, and simply take their turn as normal.

It may be possible for Units on both parties to ambush (eachother or other units).

Acts and Actions

Action Points and Actions

Heroes all have 3 Action Points on their Turn, which they can spend however they like; attacking, casting a magic Spell, or anything you can think of that uses your hands (usually).

Moving a number of meters up to your Movement Speed takes 1 Action Point.

Attacking, casting Spells, or doing other Acts take a varying number of Action Points, depending on the Ability or weapon. This cost is written explicitly on all Abilities and weapons in the game.

Think of 1 Action Point as doing something that requires only 1 Hand. Attacking with a Dagger only costs 1 Action Point, but attacking with a Greatsword costs 2 Action Points, because you need both hands.

But it gets better! You don't actually need to keep track of which hand you used already! It doesn't matter you already used your right hand. 1 Action Point is 1 Action Point. Use them at leisure!

If you have a shield and a 1-Handed Sword, yes, you can make 3 attacks with the same hand with the same sword.

There are no diminishing returns for doing the same thing over and over again.

Reaction

You have 1 Reaction per Round. Some Abilities allow you to use your Reaction. Otherwise, you have nothing to do with it.

Initiative Rundown

On your first Turn each Combat, you have an extra number of Action Points equal to your Initiative.

Acts

Simply put, doing anything willingly on your Turn is considered an Act.

Doing an Act means Moving, using a Reaction or doing anything worth 0 or more Actions. Effects triggered by or through Passives are not considered Acts.

For example, when you Move, that is an Act. Using a the Innervate Spell takes 0 Action Points, so it's an Act. When the Cleric's Passive Spell Awe triggers, that is NOT considered an Act.

Engaging in Roleplay is not considered an Act, unless the Quest Master decides so.

Stunts

A Hero may attempt a Stunt - doing something unconventional to attempt to deal more Damage or apply a certain effect.

For example, if a Player wants to do a falling attack on a monster, or try to burn a specific part of a monster's fur, or shout so hard that rocks fall from the ceiling.

Attempting a Stunt requires a Check.

Passing a Stunt Check might give bonuses such as +50% extra Damage (or even +100% for one-handed weapons), Single-Stunning the target, dealing extra Damage in an Area, healing for an amount around 1d10, etc.

Failing a Stuns usually means losing the Action Points for that Stunt.

Repeating Stunts

After someone attempts a Stunt, that Stunt may never be repeated in the same party or with the same Quest Master, by anyone in the party, ever.

Ultimately, the Quest Master has the final word on whether a Stunt may or may not be done.

Movement

Movement (Moving)

Every Unit can move in combat. When you see the term "move", "moving", "Movement", etc, that always refers to walking, running, jumping, etc.

Using 1 Action Point, you can move once a number of meters equal to your Speed.

You can't split your Movement around other Acts. For example, if you spend 1 Action Point to move just 1 meter, then decide to do anything (e.g. attack, or even do something free), then want to move again, you must use another Action Point.

Unused Movement is not carried over!

Note that you can freely switch direction while moving, if it's in the same movement. If you want, you can move in one direction for a few meters, do a 180 degree turn and move back. That is valid movement.

Jumping

As part of your normal Movement, you can freely jump a number of meters equal to your Instinct, without needing a Check.

Slamming or Pushing

Some Abilities "Slam", "push" or "pull" Units (pulling is just pushing in the opposite direction).

When a Unit is Slammed, pushed, teleported, etc (or when you do it to yourself), it does not cost 1 Action Point. If an Ability says a Unit "moves a number of meters...", it does not use Action Points unless it explicitly says so. Slamming or pushing a Unit does not consume that Unit's movement.

A Unit may use a Reaction to grab onto a ledge or object when Slammed or pushed. They stop and, if Slammed, take the Slam Damage as if they hit an obstacle where they stop.

Opportunity Attacks

There are no opportunity attacks in Quest Guard. Movement usually has no penalties.

Other Movement

Jumping takes away from Movement meters, whether vertical or horizontal.

So, if you decide to jump 1 meter ahead, this still takes 1 meter of movement, as it normally would (the QM might make you roll a Check for succeeding the jump, though).

Climbing a 2 meter wall takes 2 meters out of your movement. If you are jumping both horizontally and vertically, you only use the movement for the horizontal movement (e.g. if you jump to a ledge 1 meter away that's 1 meter tall, this only uses 1 meter; similarly, if you are jumping to a ledge 3 meters away that's 2 meters tall, this takes only 3 meters out of your movement).

Moving through Units

You can move normally through Allied Units' spaces. Only Units smaller in size can move through enemy Units of a larger size (e.g. Small may move through Medium, Medium may move through Large, etc).

For them, those spaces underneath the larger Unit count as Hard Terrain.

Hard Terrain

Moving inside a Hard Terrain space take 2 meters instead of 1.

Moving outside of Hard Terrain to normal terrain costs 1 meter of movement, as normal.

Combat Encounter & Units

Combat Encounter

When you want to fight, the game switches from free roleplay to combat.

Unit

Any acting person, monster or creature is considered a Unit (e.g. it's not inanimate and can take turns).

Inanimate objects can be considered Units only if and when you're targeting or affecting them with attacks or Abilities, and it's necessary that they be considered Units (e.g. for certai special effects).

The QM has the final say in whether something is a Unit or not.

Ally vs Enemy

A friendly Unit is considered an Ally. A hostile Unit is considered an Enemy.

Inanimate Unit objects are considered

neither Allies, nor Enemies.

Worthiness (Worthy Enemy)

Worthiness describes whether something is done in good faith within the fiction of the game, rather than for a mechanical meta-game advantage.

Something is Worthy if it fits the narrative context and is not done primarily to gain an unintended mechanical advantage.

Anything can be Worthy (a Worthy reason), but the 2 most common uses are for Worthy Combat and Worthy Enemies. A Worthy Enemy is a normal enemy that tries to kill you during a combat encounter only.

Certain Abilities specify that they only work against "Worthy Enemies".

The following are ^not^ considered Worthy:

- ◊ Defenseless Units (e.g. civillians, hunted deer, etc) and Units that don't attack or don't want to attack
- ◊ Non-Units (e.g. air, the ground, a tree, etc)
- ◊ Temporarily equipping an magical armor to gain a roleplay advantage, then unequipping it immediately after
- ◊ "Time-skip combats" (quick combat, encounters resolved through roleplaying, etc)
- ◊ A character's name that is clearly intended as a joke
- ◊ Every single creature in a swarm (e.g. a single bat is not a Worthy Enemy, but a Bat Swarm as a Unit is)

Apply common sense. Ultmately, the Quest Master has the final word on whether something is Worthy or not, and may forbid certain non-Worthy situations. Note that this should not be done to railroad the players and force them on a certain path, but to keep the story believable, immersive, and prevent unintended meta-gaming situations.

Unit Sizes

Medium and smaller Units occupy a 1x1 meter space.

Large Units occupy a 2x2 meter space. It is up to the QM to tell how much space a Unit larger than Large occupies, and how well it can fit through gaps and units.

When moving a Large Unit (or larger), count the number of meters it moved from the center of its starting space to the center of its end space.

If someone is a smaller size than another Unit, that someone may move through the space of that Unit as if it were Hard Terrain.

Hitting only one space of a Large or larger Unit with an Area Ability is perfectly valid (has no special penalties, deals full Damage as if it hit fully, etc).

Carrying Units

A Unit carrying another Unit is Slowed (and might not be able to use its hands, depending on the situation).

Mounted Combat & Riding

A Unit can spend 1 Action Point to mount or dismount another Unit at least one size larger than you. The mounted Unit can spend 1 Action Point to freely unmount the rider.

Most Units can be mounted or ridden, but unless it is Ridable (specifically purposed as a Mount), a mount is Slowed.

If the mount is Ridable, your two Turns are merged into a regular one and act together as a singular Unit (you have 3 Action Points and can control what the mount does, with your own Action Points). A mount usually provides higher Movement Speed and may have other useful Abilities.

The Ridable mount is immune to Damage from outside and can't be targeted. However, all the final Damage the rider takes (after all calculations) is also done directly to the mount, ignoring the mount's Resistances or Weaknesses or similar effects.

Simply put, you and your mount always take the same Damage.

If the mount dies, the rider unmounts and is Single-Stunned.

Apply common sense to whether a Unit is Ridable, can attack its rider, the rider has Cover from its mount, etc. Slamming, pushing, or teleporting may or may not take the mount with the rider (and viceversa), up to the Quest Master.

Damage & Status

Damage Rundown

The Damage usually works on the principle of "what you see is what you get".

Usually, there are no Damage reductions like Armor. You deal the Damage you see on the dice

Offensive Ability/Attack

An Attack or Offensive Ability is something that deals Damage or inflicts a Status Effect, coming directly from a Unit through a missile, weapon or direct Spell.

Delayed Damage sources are not considered

Attacks (e.g. Damage over time)

The Hail Spell is an attack. Magic Arrows counts as multiple attacks. Curse of Pain's Damage is not an attack.

The term "attack" is relevant for some Abilities.

The term "attack" is also sometimes used to simply refer to the Act of hitting or striking a Unit (e.g. making a melee attack). A "weapon attack" is simply the Act of attacking with a weapon.

The terms "attack" and "Offensive Act" are used interchangeably, though this will be streamlined in the near future (TODO/WIP).

Damage and Damage Types

Damage is a word for how many Health Points an attack or effect will reduce. Dealing 3 Damage to a Unit with 10 Health will leave the Unit at 7 Health. Upon reaching 0 or less Health, a Unit dies or Falls (see Death and being Fallen).

There are multiple "types" of Damage, but this is just a classification for certain Abilities, and usually 3 Damage is 3 Damage, no matter the type.

The Damage types are:

- Slash
- Smash
- Pierce
- Pulse (pressure)
- Fire
- Cold
- Shock
- Scourge (dark, necrotic, eldritch)
- Divine
- Psychic
- - True*

There are Passive Abilities ("Resistances") that reduce certain Damage types you take by 50%, or increase it by 50% ("Weaknesses").

True Damage can not be mitigated, ignores Shielding (deals directly Damage to Health) and regular Damage reductions and Resistances. There are, however, some Abilities that can reduce True Damage, but they are very rare.

If a Unit has Shielding or similar effects, True Damage directly affects Health. The Shielding is not consumed.

Damage Calculation Order

The order for calculating Damage is always additions/subtractions first, and then percentages.

The order in which Damage is added or subtracted from an Attack is:

1. Calculate all percentage penalties or additions (e.g. Blind -50%, Frail +50%, etc).

2. Calculate all non-percentage penalties and additions, including one Shielding (if any)

Percentages

All percentage calculations are additive, meaning taking +50% Damage from a source and another +50% Damage from another source results in taking +100% Damage.

The final result is always rounded down. Individual percentages are not calculated separately, but instead only the final percentage is calculated.

For example, let's say you Attack a Unit with a Handgun and you roll 8. Your attack is Blinded, the enemy has one Shielding that can block 2 Damage, takes +50% Pierce Damage, has Cover, and you are using special Bullets that deal +1 Damage.

The Damage becomes:

1. 8 + 1 (from bullets) - 2 (from Shielding) = 7

2. 100% of 7 + 50% of 7 (from the Pierce weakness) - 50% of 7 (from Cover) - 50% of 7 (from Blinded)

The +50% and -50% cancel out: 100% of 7 - 50% of 7 (from Blinded) = 50% of 7 = 3 (because we round down only the final result).

Note that for this step with percentages we do not calculate the result of each percentage individually, but we simply subtract or add to 100% to get the final percentage. Only at the end do we calculate the final number.

Shielding

A Unit may have one or more Shieldings that can block an amount of Damage.

The next time the Unit takes Damage, they must subtract exactly one of the Shieldings from the Damage being taken, then that Shielding is lost.

If it has at laast one Shielding, the Unit must block Damage with one of their Shieldings, whichever they choose.

Only one Shielding may be used to block Damage at a

time. Shieldings do not stack on top of one-another.

When an Ability says something akin to "someone gets a Shielding that can block 1d6 Damage", roll the Shielding at that moment and keep the die to represent the Shielding on that character.

My Health and Mana

How much you can resist in combat is determined by your Health Points. Every living (or undead) thing in the game has Health Points (or just Health, or HP).

your Hero has a set amount of Health Points determined by how you created your Hero.

Whenever you take Damage, you subtract that many points from your current Health Points.

If someone reaches 0 or less Health Points, they die (or at least Fall incapacitated).

In QuestGuard, you can't take "long rests" to recover Health, but you recover an amount of Health after each Worthy Combat equal to your Health Regen.

At the end of every Adventure, you recover all resources (Health, Mana, etc). The Quest Master will tell you when that happens.

Being Fallen

When you get to 0 Health, you become Fallen until you restore Health.

While Fallen, you skip your Turn for now. If you are Healed by the end of the Round, you come back (with Exhaustion) and take your Turn at the end of this Round. Later, you take the rest of your Turns in normal order.

If you are not Healed by the end of the Round, your Turn this round is completely skipped, and the same rules apply for the next Round, until you are Healed.

Exhaustion (Combat)

When you "Rise From Being Fallen", you come back to life with Exhaustion (Single-Exhaustion), which lasts until the Combat is over.

Each degree of Exhaustion stacks. If you were already Single-Exhausted, you become Double-Exhausted. If you were Double-Exhausted, you become Triple-Exhausted.

While Triple-Exhausted, if you reach 0 Health, you die.

Each level of Exhaustion reduces your Action Points per Turn by 1, and all your Damage, Healing and Rolls by 50%. At Triple-Exhausted, you have -3 Action Points per Turn, deal -150% Damage and Healing and all your Rolls get -150%.

Combat Exhaustion lasts until the end of the Combat.

Exhaustion (Non-Combat)

You also become Single-Exhausted for each 24 hours without sleep, from overdosing on potions (e.g. if you drink more than 1 potion per hour) or from magical effects.

You cure one Level of Exhaustion (Non-Combat) by sleeping for 8 hours.

Distance

When calculating distance from point A to point B, calculate the distance from the square A is on to the square B is on like this:

Start from a square near A and count squares one by one (in a line or diagonally) until you get to B. You also count the square B is on for this.

Remember this by thinking that if A is on the corner of B, that's a distance of 1 meter.

Range

To calculate the range from a Unit to another Unit, simply measure the distance from that Unit's space's center to the other Unit's space's center.

If one of the Units is Large or larger, measure the distance from one of its outer-most spaces to the one of the other Unit's outer-most spaces (e.g. for Large Units - NOT to center, but to edge).

An easy way to measure this, if you're playing on a grid, is to count the number of squares from one Unit to another. If the other Unit is in a square right next to his Unit (even diagonally), the distance is 1 meter. If there's an empty square between them, the distance is 2. And so on.

MINIMUM / MAXIMUM RANGE

Some Abilities and weapons have a minimum and maximum Range (e.g. 3-5 meters).

Attacking below the minimum range has a -50% penalty.

You can not attack beyond the maximum range of a weapon (it is considered you do not have Line of Sight).

Specified ranges are inclusive (e.g. 3-5 meters range means

you can attack normally at 3 and 5 meters range).

Melee vs Ranged

Abilities usually specify if an attack is considered melee or ranged.

All offensive Acts done within 1 meter are considered melee. All melee weapon attacks or Abilities that use melee weapons are considered melee, even if their range if more than 1 meter.

Otherwise, all other offensive Acts are considered ranged.

Darkness

Attacks on Units standing in darkness have Cover (-50% Damage).

The Quest Master will determine if a Unit has Line of Sight through darkness. Apply common sense.

There are, however,

RECOMMENDED DARKNESS RULES

In darkness, your Line of Sight is 3 meters.

When you spot a Unit in darkness, everyone may now have Line of Sight to them, unless they move further into the darkness.

If a Unit is standing in light (or is illumintated in some way), anyone may have Line of Sight to it (obviously).

Certain Spells, items and fire may illuminate areas (e.g. short bursts of fire illuminate an area in 3 meters for up to 6 seconds, aka 1 Round). Naturally, Units can see illuminated areas even if they themselves are standing in darkness.

Certain Abilities may allow Units to see well in the dark up to a specified distance (and as such they have Line of Sight up to that distance, and don't have Cover).

Line of Sight

If you can see a Unit directly, you have Line of Sight to it.

To clarify, if Unit A can see Unit B with their bare eyes, then Unit A has Line of Sight to Unit B.

If Unit A can see even a little bit of the body of Unit B, then Unit A still has Line of Sight to Unit B (but attacks usually gain the Cover pentalty, which is -2).

To use an Ability, you need Line of Sight to the center target point of where you are casting the Ability.

If playing on a grid, if you have to target a point, you target the square that point is in. You can't normally target square intersections unless the Ability states you can.

If you target a Unit, you must have Line of Sight to its square.

There is Line of Sight from square A to square B if you can draw a line from any corner of square A to any corner of square B without any other Unit or Obstacle crossing the line.

However, other Units' or obstacles' squares can _intersect_ the line you were drawing if it's merely tangential, and does not pass from one side of the line to the other.

See the example below.

Without magical means, Line of Sight is always 2-way. If Unit A has LoS to Unit B, then Unit B also has LoS to Unit A (assuming they look at one another).

Transparent solid objects (e.g. windows) do not block Line of Sight, but obviously missiles like arrows and magic bolts can't go through them. Apply common sense.

Allies do not block Line of Sight, and neither do Enemies, but attacking a target behind another Unit provides them with Cover against the attack.

Cover

An Act (attack, Spell, etc) has Cover if done "through" or over an obstacle or Unit, or Line of Sight is somewhat obstructed (fog, water, etc).

Cover reduces the total roll (or Damage, or Healing, etc) by 50%.

Whether something has Cover is up to the Quest Master's interpretation. It is possible that a Unit has Cover from another Unit, but not necessarily viceversa (e.g. if shooting from behind a rock).

Area

For Abilities that affect areas, the distance is calculated to the edge square of the area.

E.g. for a 4x4 meter area, if the range is 6 meters, there should be a path of 5 empty squares between the caster and the area.

If a spell targets a line, it starts from a square right in front of you and continues in a line.

E.g. if the line is 2 meters long, it takes the

square in front of you, and the next one.

Semi-Hitting (Area Abilities)

When playing on a grid, you might sometimes position an area Ability in such way that it somewhat hits certain Units, hits half of their Spaces, or is in an awkward shape.

A fair warning: it is not recommended that you allow awkward area positions on the board.

Semi-Hitting deals -2 Damage and Semi-Hit Units gain +2 to Checks made from it.

For example, you could position a 3x3 meter area in the center of a 4x4 meter area; thus, the 4 squares in the middle will be fully covered by the 3x3 area, but the surrounding squares will all only be covered by a half of a square from the 3x3 area (or even a quarter).

Note: a Large Unit takes the full effect even if only one space (1x1 meter) of its total area is hit (e.g. hitting only a square of the 4 squares of a Large Unit applies the normal effect - it is NOT a Semi-Hit).

"All" vs "Each"

The difference between the terms "all" and "each" in Abilities is intentional:

When you affect "all" (Units) with an effect, you only roll the dice once. If multiple of those Units must roll dice as part of the effect or as a response, each can roll its own dice separately.

When you affect "each" (Unit) with an effect, you roll the dice for each affected.

Near (Nearness)

'Near' and 'Adjacent' refers to all spaces within 1 meter of a Unit.

Falling Damage

Falling inflicts 1d6 Smash Damage for every 2 meters fallen (assuming you land on hard ground).

E.g. falling 3 meters deals 1d6 Damage, falling 4 meters deals 2d6 Damage, 5 meters - 2d6, 6 meters - 3d6, etc.

Having someone fall on you deals the same True Damage to you as it does to the faller.

The Quest Master might reduce the Damage or mitigate it depending what you land on or if you fall onto an enemy with an attack. If you're a Quest Master, consider halving the fall Damage if a Unit falls intentionately on another Unit to attack it.

Combat & Resist Checks

Some Abilities require you to make a "Check against something". To succeed, you need to roll a Check equal to or higher than the number you're rolling against. These are called Combat Checks. If you're battling against another Check, you need to roll higher than the enemy Check.

Some monster Abilities will have you make a Resist Check. These are just like normal Checks or Combat Checks. As usual, you must roll equal to or higher than the number you're rolling against in order to succeed.

Dice Upgrade/Downgrade

Having Dice Upgraded means, for example, d6's become d8's, or d10's become d12's. D12's and d20's just gain +1.

Dice Downgraded is the opposite, so it means, for example, d8's become d6's, or d10's become d8's. D2's and d20's just gain -1.

Note that Upgrading or Downgrading Dice for an Ability or weapon attack applies to all dice displayed on it! That includes special weapon text like Critical Strikes.

Status Effects

Status Effects standards

A "Status Effect" is a condition or debuff on a Unit that prevents it from doing things normally (e.g. Stunned means it has fewer Action Points, Slowed means it's harder to move, etc).

all Status Effects lasts until the end of that Unit's next Turn (or until the end of their current Turn if it's their Turn now), unless stated otherwise.

Status Effects of different types stack together (e.g. a Unit can be both Slowed and Blinded).

Most Status Effects of the same type also stack (e.g. if you make a Unit Double-Slowed, its next Move Act will cost +2 Action Points).

Slam

When a Unit is Slammed a number of meters in a direction, it is pushed that much in that direction.

If it hits another Unit or obstacle, it stops. Calculate how many meters left of the Slamming were left that it should

have been pushed if it weren't for the obstacle or Unit.

If it hit an obstacle, the Unit takes that much Smash Damage.

If it it a Unit, they both take half of that as Smash Damage.

Note that any Unit may use a Reaction to grab onto a ledge or object when Slammed. They stop and take the Slam Damage as if they hit an obstacle where they stop.

Lagged

On its next Turn, a Slowed Unit's next Move Act costs 1 extra Action Point for each level of Slow. Also affects Abilties that specify making a Move Act. Until it does, it can't use Reaction Abilities that specify making a Move Act. Other movement Abilities are unaffected (teleports, dashing, leaping, Slamming/Pushing, etc).

Deafened

On its next Turn, a Deafened Unit's next Ability costs 1 extra Action Point (except Reactions and Default Actions). For non-Heroes, this does not affect Abilities that have "Attack" in their name.

Dazed

On its next Turn, a Dazed Unit's weapon attack costs 1 extra Action Point (body parts are considered weapons). Also affects Abilities that specify using a weapon (or body parts). For non-Heroes, this only affects Abilities that have "Attack" in their name.

Stunned

A Single-Stunned Unit loses 1 Action Point on its next Turn.

A Double-Stunned Unit loses 2 Action points on its next Turn.

A Triple-Stunned Unit loses 3 Action points on its next Turn.

Stunning a Unit multiple times stacks up to Triple-Stunned.

Slowed

A Slowed Unit has -50% Movement Speed on its next Movement Act. Other movement Abilities are unaffected (teleports, dashing, leaping, Slamming/Pushing, etc).

Frailed

Next time the Unit takes Damage, it takes +50%.

Blinded

A Blinded Unit's next Damage or Healing Act does -50% Healing or Damage.

Crippled

A Crippled Unit's next Damage or Healing Act does -100% Healing or Damage.

Silenced

A Silenced Unit can not use any Abilities on its next Turn. Monsters can only use physical attacks that use only 1 Action Point.

Rooted

A Rooted Unit can not use Movement on its next Turn.

Exhaustion (Combat)

When you "Rise From Being Fallen", you come back to life with Exhaustion (Single-Exhaustion), which lasts until the Combat is over.

Each degree of Exhaustion stacks. If you were already Single-Exhausted, you become Double-Exhausted. If you were Double-Exhausted, you become Triple-Exhausted.

While Triple-Exhausted, if you reach 0 Health, you die.

Each level of Exhaustion reduces your Action Points per Turn by 1, and all your Damage, Healing and Rolls by 50%. At Triple-Exhausted, you have -3 Action Points per Turn, deal -150% Damage and Healing and all your Rolls get -150%.

Combat Exhaustion lasts until the end of the Combat.

Other Interactions

If a Unit gets affected by a Status Effect while doing an Act (e.g. you activate a trap while shooting a bow), what happens depends on the Status Effect type.

If pushed or Slammed, the Unit is Pushed immediately (and dashes are cancelled). If the Act was not started yet (e.g. not yet attacked), then the Unit is free to do something else after being Pushed if they want to. However, if the Act already started (e.g. fired 1 out of 3 Magic Missiles), the Unit must continue casting the Spell, on the same target if

it was already chosen, only if it's still valid (e.g. has Line of Sight or Range). If the Act can't be continued due to Range, Line of Sight, etc, then the rest of the Act is cancelled; Actions/Resoureces are NOT regained and are lost.

Cripple, Slow: Nothing happens on the spot; the Status Effect takes effect after the Ability finishes.

Silence: If it's a Spell, the rest of the Spell gets cancelled; otherwise nothing else happens.

Single-Stun and Double-Stun: If the target still has enough Action Points for the Act, it continues. Otherwise, it is cancelled and the Unit may do something else if it still has Action Points.

Triple-Stun and other non-listed strong Status Effect: The Ability gets cancelled.

Becoming Slowed on your turn immediately reduces your remaining Speed by 2 (but not less than 0, obviously).

Weapons and Armor

Weapons

TODO/WIP

Armor

TODO/WIP

Critical Strikes

Many weapons can land Critical Strikes if you roll maximum on one or more dice specified.

If the attack had extra Damage from other sources, and it's the same die type that can roll the required number, then also take that die into account.

For example, the Punch (1d4 Damage) lands a Critical strike if you rolled maximum on the weapon die (which means 4). However, if your attack gains another 1d4 Damage (thus making it 2d4), it will land a Critical Strike if any of the d4's rolled a 4.

If your weapon attack has its Dice Upgraded to the next die type (e.g. from 1d4 to 1d6), then the Critical Strike now happens if you roll 6 on the d6.

Throwing weapons

If you want to throw a weapon that's not baseline made for throwing, it is considered an Improvised Attack (there's a Default Move Basic Ability called Improvised Attack).

There exists a Feat called Throwing Expert that allows you to throw weapons with their normal Damage.

You still need to be Trained in that weapon to throw it without it being an Improvised Attack.

Swapping Weapons

At the start of your turn, you can freely choose what weapons to use or swap for the rest of your turn.

For example, when your turn starts, you can choose to prepare one Shortsword and a Shield, or a Greatclub, or a Hand Crossbow and a Dagger.

You can use these weapons however you like on your turn.

If you ever want to swap weapons in the middle of your turn, you must spend 1 Action Point.

Changing weapons at the start of your turn is encouraged! Use different weapons to your advantage!

Aiming

You can not aim for a specific area when attacking of using an Ability.

However, in niche cases, the Quest Master might allow a Stunt to try to hit a specific point of a Unit.

Abilities

Abilities explained

An Ability is simply a block of text that either gives you something extra (passively) or gives you something else to do with your Action Points rather than attacking.

Most things in Quest Guard are Abilities: weapons, Spells, Feats, etc.

Abilities have an icon, name, tags for various important things like Cost, Range, etc.

Abilities can be either Passive or active. Passive Abilities give you an effect that is generally applicable, and usually you do not need to "activate" them specifically; they activate on their own.

Active Abilities require Action Points (maybe even 0 Action Points!) in order to activate them manually.

One quick way to differentiate Passive from Active

Abilities is that Active Abilities have a square icon, while Passive Abilities have a rounder icon!

0 Action Points

If an Ability costs 0 Action Points, you can use it as many times as your Mana or Cooldown allows.

These are considered an Act.

Ability Limit Per Turn

There is no limit to how many Abilities you can use on your Turn.

Ability Text

The base block of text for an Ability is the effect of that Ability - its bread-and-butter. It's written in normal text, and explains simply what the Ability does. The smaller black text below the effect usually provides some extra information, like certain exceptions or cases, or explains some extra rules. The even smaller gray text in italics are the notes of the Ability. These usually provide clarifications for how the Ability works, and sometimes describes the flavor of the Ability.

The easiest way to keep track of your Abilities is to either use the Character Creator on the website (under Create A Character), or with the Ability Sheet Maker, at the Game menu, under Abilities, on the Ability Sheet Maker page.

Ability Tags

Written with white text on dark background on small rectangles are the tags of the Ability. These don't add extra information, but are just meant as quick reference to see what kind of Ability it is at a glance.

Cooldown

Some Abilities have a Cooldown.

Cooldown refers to the time you must wait to use the Ability again.

An Ability's Cooldown is represented by the _white hourglass_ icon. If an Ability has no such icon, then it has no Cooldown and can be used as often as you like.

A Cooldown of "Once / Adventure" means you can use the Ability once, and then can't use it again until you finish the current Adventure.

Some Abilities have a Cooldown mentioning "real hours" or other real time. This refers to the real-world time.

A "Once / real hour" Ability can be used once, and then you must wait one hour in order to use it again.

Duration

Duration on Abilities is usually self-explanatory.

Abiliy Requirements

Abilities may have requirements to use. This is noted with an {Color('orange', 'orange text')} in the tags section of the Ability (e.g. Action Points cost, Cooldown, Requirement, Range, etc).

The most common requirement is "Only usable in Worthy Combat", which can't be cast outside of Combat.

For what a Worthy Combat is, see the Worthy Combat section of these rules.

Ability Replacement/Upgrade

You will encounter Abilities that replace other Abilities. This is noted with a {Color('blue', 'blue text')} in the tags section of the Ability (e.g. Action Points cost, Cooldown, Replacement, Range, etc).

If an Ability you have says "Replaces X", then you don't need to look at the replaced Ability anymore. This is mostly for convenience, so you don't need to clutter your Hero Sheet/ Ability Sheet with extra Abilities you will no longer use.

The "My Character" section of the Character Creator automatically hides replaced Abilities.

Some Abilities replace other Abilities, and will list both "Requires X" and "Replaces X".

In that case, you need to already have picked the required/replaced Ability. That Ability still counts as a picked Talent if it's a Talent!

For example, let's say you picked Hail as a Warlock. At a higher Level, there is an Ability called Hail Torrent, which requires and replaces Hail. If you choose to get this, you must still have Hail in your build, and don't get a free different pick for a Class Talent at Level 1!

Triggering Abilities

Some Abilities give you free uses of other Abilities. For example, Clerics get to cast Awe for free, even if it's on a Cooldown.

When an Ability tells you that you can "freely cast X ignoring its Cooldown/Cost", you can cast that Ability

in that moment, whether it's on Cooldown or not.

If it's not on Cooldown, the Ability does NOT go on Cooldown if you trigger a free cast like this.

If it's on Cooldown, the Ability remains on Cooldown.

Spells

A Spell is an Ability made with magic.

All Spells are Abilities, but only some Abilities are Spells. This only matters in certain niche scenarios.

There is no limit to how many Spells you can use per Turn.

Mana

Many Classes in the game use a system of points called Mana Points.

You have a number of Mana Points that you can spend to cast some Spells, and you regain all Mana Points back when you start a new Adventure.

Even many non-spellcaster Classes use Mana.

The amount of Mana a Spell costs to cast is represented by the _blue flame_ icon and the number near it.

Each Spell specifies if and how many Mana Points it costs to cast. If you decide to cast Healing Surge, you must expend one Mana Point. If you don't have enough Mana Points to use an Ability, you simply can't.

You can use the Character Creator tool to keep track of your Mana, on the My Character tab, on the bottom-right of the online character sheet.

If playing with pen-and-paper, you can keep track of your Mana Points on a sheet of paper, with marbles, dice, etc. It is your job to keep track of your Mana Points. Don't cheat!

Feats

There exist a set of extra Abilities called Feats (which you can find on the {Feats} page). These usually change how you play your Hero or give you some extra interesting options, but always have a cost attached (usually in Max Health, Mana, Initiative, etc).

You can get as many of these as you can afford.

Feats are optional, and you're not necessarily missing out if you decide to play without Feats.

Feat Costs

If you can't afford to get a Feat (e.g. don't have enough Max Mana to sacrifice), you can't get the Feat.

For example, if a Feat costs 1 Focus but your Focus is already 0 or less, you can't spend Focus to buy the Feat.

Somatic, Verbal, Material...

No such thing. Spells just require Actions, Mana, etc. As long as your hands are free and are not Silenced, you can cast Spells.

There is also no such thing as maintaining ^concentration^. If a Spell has a delayed effect (e.g. Lightning Storm which strikes again), it happens regardless of whether you are Stunned or incapacitated, unless it specifically says so.

Character Advancement

Leveling Up

Once your Hero has gone through enough of the story, it Levels Up.

When you Level Up, depending on your Class, you gain:

- Max Health

- Health Regen

- +1 in a Stat of choice (up to a limit, detailed below)

- 1 Talent from your new Level's tier

Based on your Class, you may also get:

- +1 Mana

Leveling Up By Milestone

The recommended way to Level Up characters is by reaching an important milestone in the story - after completing a quest, defeating a certain boss, etc.

The Quest Master will let you know when you Level Up by milestone.

The recommended number of sessions required to get to the next Level is equal to the current Level.

For example, reaching from Level 1 to Level 2 would require 1 session, from Level 2 to Level 3 - 2 sessions, and so on.

Leveling Up By Experience

You might also Level Up your Heroes based on Experience Points.

To get to the next Level, you need to get more Experience Points equal to 100 times the next Level.

For example, reaching from Level 1 to Level 2 would require 200 Experience Points, from Level 2 to Level 3 - 300 Experience Points, and so on.

Defeating enemies awards Experience Points. After winning a Combat, the Quest Master distributes the sum of Experience Points of all enemies defeated, and equally distributes it to the Heroes.

More details on Enemy Experience in the rules for balancing a Combat Encounter.

The Quest Master might also award Experience Points for roleplaying, exploration, etc.

Talents

Every Level, your Class gives you a Talent to pick from multiple available Talents.

All Talents are Abilities.

All Classes have Talent tiers for all Levels from 1 to 10.

Starting even from Level 1 and when you reach a certain Level, you get one of the available Talents from that Level's Talent Tiers for free.

If there are multiple Talent Tiers for that Level, you can pick one from each (see Talent Clarifications).

There are 2 Talent Types: Race Talents (given by the Race) and Class Talents (given by the Class).

Minor and Utility Talents

Minor and Utility Talents are Abilities that are usually extra things you can do in and outside Combat.

Aside from the free 1 Talent for each Talent tier, you may pick an extra number of Minor and/or Utility Talents equal to your Focus.

Potentially, you could have all Class Talents from a certain Level!

Relearning/Unlearning/Respecing

All Classes can unlearn and re-learn their Talents inbetween Adventures.

Inbetween Adventures, Heroes can "respec their Talents", meaning they can change any of their Talent Choices, freely.

When unlearning a Talent, the Hero loses te passive benefits of that Talent (e.g. Talents that state something like "You have +1 something...").

However, you keep all permanent bonuses a Talent gave you if they are explicitly called "permanent".

Character Stats, Specializations, Quirks and Feats generally can't be changed, unless the Quest Master allows for this in special circumstances, with things such as a Tome of Unlearning item or undergoing intensive training for a

period of time, to retrain the character's capabilities.

There are, however, options to change some of these. You can view them at the Game menu, under Other, on the Shop & Prices page.

Items

Items (using items)

Most items you can use in combat take 1 Action Point to make (e.g. Scrolls, Potions, Caltrops, etc).

Even if an Ability normally takes 0 Action Points, the scroll still takes 1 Action Point to use. For example, if you have a Scroll of Smite, you must first land a weapon attack, then use the scroll to add the extra Damage (just like Smite says, but with 1 Action Point).

There might be situations in which using a Scroll is not feasible.

Potions

Consuming a Potion takes a 1 Action Point.

Every Unit can safely use at most one "Potion" per in-game hour. If a brew restores Health, Mana, Movement, etc (e.g. is not a lasting buff), it counts as a "Potion". Magical foods with similar properties count as Potions. The Quest Master can choose to rule something as "not a Potion", which means it can be safely consumed, as per the item's rules.

The second Potion consumed per hour makes the Unit suffer of Exhaustion for 1 hour.

The third and all further Potions consumed per hour make the user pass a Grade 12 Might Check or fall to 0 Health and fall in a coma (Unconscious) for 1 hour.

Scrolls

A scroll is usually a piece of parchment that has a Spell infused in it. When used, the Scroll releases that Spell and the scroll destroyed. Scrolls are one-time use items.

Using a Scroll takes 1 Action Point

You don't need to be a spellcaster to use a Scroll, or expend Mana. Scrolls ignore cooldowns on your Abilities - they have nothing to do with your own Ability Cooldowns or Costs.

When using a scroll, you use your own Stats for that Spell (e.g. your Focus, your Presence, etc).

The scroll Spell does not benefit from effect bonuses increased by your Hero's Levels or by Talents. It is simply a plain copy of a Spell.

Magic Item Shop

As a Quest Master, be careful with how you allow Players to buy scrolls from Shops! Players should not be able to buy all the scrolls they need and stock up on, say, 6 Fireball Scrolls they can just use on a whim.

Shop stocks should be limited to a few different scrolls and potions to buy.

Magic Items and Soulbound

Magic items are powered by the soul of their carrier!

Once a magic item is equipped or used, it becomes Soulbound to that character until the end of the Adventure. An item that is Soulbound to a Unit has no effect in someone else's hand, does not provide any benefit other than the default ones if it's an armor, and acts as a regular weapon if it's a weapon.

Don/Doff Armor

At the start of each Adventure, you decide what armor you want to have equipped. It can not be unequipped for the rest of the Adventure except for a ^worthy reason^, such as unequipping an armor set to replace it with a different newly acquired one.

For example, it is not a ^worthy reason^ to unequip a plate armor to equip a robe that grants +1 History so you can roll that Check with the bonus, then to reequip the Plate.

Non-Combat and Time

Checks

Whenever a Unit wants to do something that's not guaranteed to succeed (e.g. jumping over a chasm), the Unit rolls 2d6 and adds one fitting Stat (Might, Instinct, Focus, etc). Generaly, the Quest Master will call out for a Unit to roll a Check to determine whether they succeed at it.

If the Unit has Skill Points in any other non-Combat Skill, they may add those to the roll. Non-Heroes can't normally be Skilled in anything. The Quest Master might have an NPC be Skilled at something and provide themselves a bonus for it, of their choice.

Multiple-People Checks

Whenever the Quest Master calls for someone to

make a non-Combat Roll, only one person, usually the most qualified for that task, may be the leader of that main Roll, but others can make helping Checks.

The main Check is made normally, with all bonuses that apply.

Choose the right person for the main Roll, especially if that character should be better at that Check, even if they don't have that particular non-Combat Skill.

Helping Check

When attempting to help someone else, a character can roll a Helping Check, and add the result to the main Check.

A Helping Check is equal to a normal Check, minus 10 (can add the Stat and non-combat Skill).

Helping must be declared before the main Roll.

Rolling With Events on the helping Check may or may not trigger the event.

For example, let's assume the most qualified character rolls a main Focus Check for a total of 2d6 + 5, and another character decides to roll a Helping Check for a total of 2d6 + 1.

If the main Focus Check resulted in 11 (e.g. 2 + 4 + 5), and the Helping Check resulted in -2 (7 + 1 - 10), then the final result of the main Check is 9.

Repeating Checks

Focus Checks normally can't be repeated - if one fails an Focus, then they simply don't know, aren't able to comprehend it no matter how hard they try, or can't sense what they're supposed to.

If the main Check, with or without help doesn't know something, it becomes very unlikely that someone else knows it.

Might Checks normally can't be repeated unless the character tries a different approach (up to the Quest Master's interpretation).

Instinct and Presence Checks may sometimes be repeated, but, normally, the failure is more disrupting.

Leading Checks and Helping

If multiple players want to make the same Check (e.g. inspecting for traps, remembering informatio, etc), determine (the Quest Master or the players) which Hero is the most qualified for it.

Only the most qualified character rolls the Check.

Other characters may try to roll a Helping Check, to help the character rolling the main Check.

Adventure System

An Adventure is a period of gameplay defined by the QM. An Adventure could be one full dungeon, one quest, one session, or just one day outdoors adventuring.

Heroes regain all resources (Health, Mana, Cooldowns, etc) at the end of an Adventure (inbetween Adventures).

For combat purposes, it is recommended that an Adventure contain 3 Medium-difficulty combats (or 2 difficult ones). Combat difficulty is calculated by the Quest Master via total Monster Experience (see Monsters).

Characters can also "respec" inbetween Adventures - can choose different Talents and Known Abilities.

There is no concept of "long resting" in Questguard - you only regain spent resources inbetween Adventures.

Quest System

The Quest System is an alterntive to the Adventure System (tentative).

A completed Quest (or Sidequest) is a milestone for the players. When the players reach that milestone in the story (complete a Quest), they regain all resources.

In short, Players regain all resources upon completing a Quest. Players heal for an amount equal to their Health Regen when completing a Sidequest.

The Quest Master decides what a Completed Quest or Sidequest is - it could be the end of a dungeon, saving someone, or finishing the game session.

For combat purposes, it is recommended that a Quest contain a total of 3 Medium-difficulty combats (or 2 difficult ones), assuming no Sidequests. Combat difficulty is calculated by the Quest Master via total Monster Experience (see Monsters).

Players can relearn Abilities and Talents after completing a Quest.

A Quest may or can't have a clearly defined start or end.

As a QM, feel free to say a Quest is complete whenever you feel the players need to recover their

resources. If the players ask “Was this a quest?” you have the option to say “It was a Sidequest”.

Combat Grace Period

For 10 minutes after finishing a combat encounter, all Units who participated are still considered in combat.

Some Abilities and game mechanics (e.g. Health Regen) require you to be out of combat to use.

Be on your toes for a while after finishing a fight!

Fire on Mount Hyhelm

Chapter Section

Miau miau miau.

Who Is This for

This book is intended for beginner Game Master and players who have never played QuestGuard.

What To Expect

Fire on Mount Hyhelm follows a group of 3 to 5 players, on an adventure that will last one single session, start to finish (3 to 5 hours). Of course, you can do the adventure in multiple sessions, depending on the time you want to spend playing.

As a Game Master, you are not required to read this book in advance. Fire on Mount Hyhelm was made to be read at a glance - it requires minimal preparation. However, please read everything up until Chapter 1 before you begin, to learn how to use this book. Once you get to Chapter 1, simply let the book guide you.

The book contains many read-aloud sections, and flows top-to-bottom, left-to-right and will guide you through everything you need to say and do.

This adventure also teaches the players the basic rules of QuestGuard.

Your Responsibility

As a Game Master, you will be the narrator and referee of the game. You present situations, and players will try to do things in those situations. A lot of the times, a Check is required (a roll of a die) to determine if the player succeeds in their action.

You will be responsible for reading passages out loud for your players, roleplaying as non-player characters (e.g. speaking in the voice of another character or conveying what they are saying), controlling the monsters in fights (e.g. rolling dice for them) and, usually, making sure every player gets their time in the spotlight and is having a good time.

How to Read It

This section explains how to read the book and interpret the various elements.

Read-Alouds

When you encounter text with a tan background like this one, read it out loud for the players. For example:

> You come across a narrow river that blocks your path forward. The river smells of salt, thick muck flows through it. What do you do?

There will be a lot of these and they will narrate not just story elements, but also rules.

As a Game Master, **a lot of the information you have is from read-alouds.** These read-alouds will serve as information for both you and the players.

NPC Replies

In some sections, NPC's (non-player characters from the story) will have potential replies to say. Here is an example for a random peasant players encounter:

> "Welcome to our village, adventurers!"
> "You look hungry. Head over to the tavern, they serve good food!"
>
> ...I did see a strange man in the woods last night!
> ...No, I never stole anything in my life! [lie, he stole coins from the church donation box]

You will see read-alouds with NPC replies.

The first few lines, in quotes, are dialogue lines meant to be said directly by the NPC (e.g. casually mentioning them in a conversation). For example, say the first dialogue line, wait for the players' response, and if you see fit, say the next dialogue line. Rinse and repeat.

Lines starting with ... are meant to be only answers to questions players ask, and should not be given without being asked specifically about the subject.

Bold phrases or words are emphasized to easily come into your view in case players ask about it.

If an NPC has no dialogue lines about a subject, then they don't know about it.

NPC's - When In Doubt...

When in doubt of what an NPC would say, resort to them saying "I don't know" or a similar reply.

Don't worry - you will get good information on NPC's that is easily readable at a glance, without requiring preparation. Feel free to paraphrase NPC dialogue lines.

Suspicion (0 to 20)

Each NPC has a secret Suspicion level from 0 (is completely friendly and trusts the players) to 20 (will not even talk to the players or is outright hostile).

Whenever the players try to persuade an NPC and the NPC isn't sure of what to do, have the players roll a Charisma Check at least equal to the NPC's Suspicion.

On a successful Check, decrease Suspicion by 1. Otherwise increase it by 1.

If players say something insulting or fitting to the conversation, increase or reduce Suspicion by 1.

Keep track of the NPC's Suspicion.

Depending on how mild or crazy the player's idea is, feel free to secretly give a +5 or -5 to their Check.

Decreasing Suspicion will unlock certain dialogue lines

Locations & Sections

The book's chapters function as Locations.

Each "chapter" is a separate Location that contains read-alouds, artwork, scenarios, etc.

Here is an example:

The Windmill

As you ascend the winding cobblestone path, you approach a decrepit fence. Pushing through the rotting wood, you arrive at the entrance of an old wooden windmill, now reclaimed by nature, overgrown with vegetation. The air carries a musty scent, tinged with the earthly smell of decaying wood, hinting that has been standing for centuries, untouched by human hands in many decades.

If Sections

Some sections are titled "If…".

Only read these sections if the title applies. If not, skip them and continue.

For example:

If There Are 5 Players…

As [player 5] enters the windmill, the floorboards crack open and [player 5] falls through into a stone basement.

Returning to Locations

If players return to a location or NPC, don't repeat the same read-alouds or dialogue lines (unless they specifically ask for it).

Props

The adventure contains paper props, such as a map, secret letters, etc. Only give these out when instructed by the book. Keep them secret until the book tells you to show it to the players.

Sometimes the book will tell you to show the players a picture of something. You can use a phone, TV screen or a laptop to show them the picture, which you will find in the Digital Appendix.



Combats

You will have to control monsters in combats. The book will tell you how to run each monster when the time comes.

Read the following guidelines, but don't overthink them. They will come in handy later.

Running Combats

When running combats, try to spread the enemies as evenly as possible on the players (e.g. if you have 4 enemies and 4 players, each enemy should attack a different player). Dying in the first round is no fun!

...unless players want to spread the damage differently (e.g. if the knight wants to front-line and take the damage instead of the mage in the back).

Battle Maps

Each combat encounter comes with a battle map, which you can find in the Appendix. If you're playing online, you can use the exact map. If you're playing on a table with pen and paper, you can draw a sketch of what the battle map looks like.

You can skip some of the details when drawing (e.g. trees, rocks, etc) unless it specifically says that thing is important to the map.The map annotations are self-explanatory. Diamonds represent player or allied Units (creatures). Blue for players, green for allies, yellow for neutral. Circles represent enemies. Red for hostile, orange for possibly hostile.



Important: Knowledge is Power

Player knowledge is key to them succeeding in combat. When a monster uses a special Ability, tell the players the exact effect of the Ability.

When the players hit a monster and it has a weakness or a resistance, let them know that their hit was not very effective (or that it was).

You may keep Monster numbers hidden, but make sure you track them (e.g. Health, Stats, etc).

If ever a player wants to know more about a monster, let them roll an Intelligence Check.

Every GM does narrates, tracks and manages combat differently - feel free to use your intuition on how to run monsters, but keep it simple and follow the rules.

